This is an excellent stock, with a good balance of flavors. The potato means it will not be clear, but since it is being used in a soup, that doesn't matter.

vegetable stock

MAKES 1 QT (1 L) **PREP** 5 MINS **COOK** 35 MINS **FREEZE** 3 MONTHS

1 leek, thickly sliced
1 large carrot, thickly sliced
2 celery ribs, thickly sliced
1 onion, coarsely chopped
2½oz (75g) button or cremini mushrooms, quartered
1 medium potato, thickly sliced
1 tomato, quartered
3 parsley stems
2 bay leaves
4 sprigs of thyme
1.5 quarts (1.5 liters) cold water

1 Put all the ingredients into a large pot. Bring to a boil, then lower the heat, cover with a lid, and simmer very gently for 30 minutes.

2 Strain the stock through a fine sieve, pressing the ingredients well against the sides of the sieve to extract all the liquid. Let cool completely, then chill in a covered container for up to 3 days before use.



light and fragrant
A flavorful vegetable stock makes a good alternative to chicken stock, whether you are vegetarian or not.